

-- quick guide · 10 commands

SQL

SQL explained for beginners.

Ten keywords that handle **90% of your day** with databases.



scan for
the full source

SELECT

Ask a table for the columns you need.

 means **all of them**.

* means **all of them**.

```
select.sql

-- all columns
SELECT * FROM users;

-- only the ones you need
SELECT name, email FROM users;
```

```
SELECT * FROM users;
```

```
SELECT name, email FROM users;
```



WHERE

Keep only the rows that **match**.

Like a search box inside the table: **filter** and keep just what you care about.

```
where.sql
```

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE age ≥ 18
      AND country = 'MX';
```



-- 03 · sort

ORDER BY

Sort the result **your way.**

Ascending by default; add **DESC** for **highest first**.

● ● ● order.sql

```
SELECT name, age FROM users
ORDER BY age DESC;
```



-- 04 · cap rows

LIMIT

Ask for just a few rows.

Perfect for **top-N** lists and fast table previews.

● ● ● limit.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
ORDER BY created_at DESC
LIMIT 10;
```



-- 05 · combine tables

JOIN

Glue two tables by a **shared column**.

Data lives split (users, orders). JOIN connects them by a key, like `user_id`.

● ● ● join.sql

```
SELECT u.name, o.total
FROM users u
JOIN orders o
      ON o.user_id = u.id;
```

-- 06 · aggregate

GROUP BY

Collapse rows into one per group.

Pair it with `COUNT`, `SUM` or `AVG` to **summarize** your data.

● ● ● group.sql

```
SELECT country, COUNT(*)  
FROM users  
GROUP BY country;
```



-- 07 · search text

LIKE

Match text by a pattern.

`%` is a wildcard: `'A%'` means **starts with A**.

like.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE name LIKE 'A%';
```


INSERT

Add a new row to a table.

List the columns, then the **values** that fill them.

●●● insert.sql

```
INSERT INTO users (name, age)
VALUES ('Ada', 36);
```



-- 09 • change data

UPDATE

Edit rows that already exist.

No **WHERE** means you change **every row**. Never forget it.

● ● ● update.sql

```
UPDATE users
SET age = 37
WHERE id = 1;
```



-- 10 • remove data

DELETE

Remove rows you no longer need.

Same rule: no **WHERE**, and the **whole table** is gone.

delete.sql

```
DELETE FROM users
WHERE id = 1;
```

-- that's the 90%

You just learned the core of SQL.

Master these ten and you can query almost any database. Which one do you reach for most?



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